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Databricks SQL alerts

This page provides step-by-step guidance for enabling and using Databricks SQL alerts to automate query execution, evaluate custom conditions, and deliver notifications when those conditions are met. With alerts, you can proactively monitor your business data and receive timely notifications whenever reported values fall outside of expected thresholds. When you schedule an alert, its associated query runs and the alert criteria are checked, regardless of any existing schedules on the underlying query. Additionally, you can access an alert history to review the results of past alert evaluations.

To learn how to work with legacy alerts instead, see [What are legacy alerts?](#).

Enable alerts in your workspace

This feature is in [Public Preview](#). Workspace admins can control workspace access to this preview from the [Previews page](#). Enabling this preview doesn't impact your existing alerts; you can continue using both these and [legacy alerts](#) in parallel.

View and organize alerts

Click the  **Alerts** in the sidebar to open the alerts listing page.

Alerts Create alert					
Alerts Legacy alerts					
Filter alerts ☐ Only my alerts Status ▾					
Name ⇅	Status	Schedule	Owner	Created at ⇅	
Frequent restart	Not Run	Every 1 day		May 12, 2025	
OS version compliance check	OK	Every 1 day		May 12, 2025	
Network errors	OK	Every 1 day		May 12, 2025	
Memory usage high	Triggered	Every 1 day		May 12, 2025	
Disk near full	Error	Every 1 day		May 12, 2025	
CPU usage high	Not Run	Every 1 day		May 12, 2025	

- The **Alerts** tab is open by default and shows all alerts in the workspace. You can type to filter by name. Click **Only my alerts** to show only alerts where you are the owner.
- The **Legacy alerts** tab shows alerts that were created using the previous alerts system.
- **Name** shows the string name of each alert.
- **Status** shows whether the alert status is `TRIGGERED`, `OK`, or `ERROR`.
- **Schedule** shows the last updated time or date.
- **Owner** shows the username of the person who owns the alert.
- **Created at** shows the date and time the alert was created.
 - `TRIGGERED` means that on the most recent execution, the **Value** column in your target query met the **Condition** and **Threshold** you configured. If your alert checks whether "cats" is above 1500, your alert will be triggered as long as "cats" is above 1500.
 - `OK` means that on the most recent query execution, the **Value** column did not meet the **Condition** and **Threshold** you configured. This doesn't mean that the **Alert** was not previously triggered. If your "cats" value is now 1470, your alert will show as `OK`.
 - `ERROR` indicates that an error occurred during alert evaluation.

Create an alert

The steps in this section walk you through how to create the alert shown in the following image. Use the labels and explanations to understand each component.

1. **Query editor:** Write and test the query that you want to alert on.

2. **Schedule:** Set a periodic schedule for the alert to run.

3. **Condition:** Select the value threshold that should trigger an alert notification. You can run the query to test the condition from this section.

4. **Notifications:** Indicate which users or notification destinations should be alerted when the threshold value falls outside of the expected range.

5. **Advanced:** Use advanced settings to alert on special values and conditions.

❗ IMPORTANT

During the Public Preview period, alerts do not support queries with [parameters](#). See [What are legacy alerts?](#).

Use the following steps to create an alert:

1. Click  **Alerts** in the sidebar and click **Create Alert**.

2. Copy and paste the following query in the query editor. Click **Run all (1000)**. To learn more about working with the SQL editor, see [Write queries and explore data in the new SQL editor](#).

SQL

```
SELECT
  to_date(tpcp_pickup_datetime) as date,
  SUM(fare_amount) as amount
FROM
  `samples`.`nyctaxi`.`trips`
GROUP BY
  ALL
ORDER BY
  1 DESC
```

3. In the **Condition** field, set the conditions that should trigger the alert.

Condition

Trigger alert when

First row ▾	amount ▾	> ▾
Static Value ▾	4000	

Test condition

Apply the following settings as shown:

- Select **Sum** as the data value to check. Alert conditions can be set on the first value of a column in the query result, or you can choose to set an aggregation across all the rows of a single column, such as SUM or AVERAGE.
- Select **amount** as the column to check.
- Select > (greater than) as the logical operator to apply.
- Set the threshold value to **Static value** 4000. **Static value** is selected by default. Enter 4000 into the value field.

4. Click **Test condition** to preview the alert and test whether the alert would trigger with the current data. The provided settings should trigger the alert. You can  Ask Genie

change the threshold value to test further.

5. In the **Notifications** section, search for your user name and click on it when it appears.
6. Click  the calendar icon to open the **Edit schedule** dialog. Use the drop-down menus to set the alert so that it runs **Every 5 minutes** from **0 minutes past the hour**. Click **Save**. Optionally, select the **Show cron syntax** checkbox to edit the schedule in [Quartz Cron Syntax](#).
7. Click **View alert**.

Your alert is saved and runs on the schedule you provided. The data used in this example is static, so if your **Test condition** returned as **Triggered**, it will again the next time it runs. You receive an email notification as an alert. If the **Test condition** returned **OK**, no notification is sent.

Review alert details

A page opens to show your alert details. Additionally, an alert history is shown with evaluation history details. Click the **Run now** button to run the alert query immediately and return the result on this screen.

Click **Edit** in the top right corner of the page to continue editing the alert.

Advanced settings

Click **Advanced settings** to apply the following settings:

- **Notify on ok:** Send a notification when the alert returns as **OK**.
- **Notification frequency:** Periodically send notifications on an alert until the status returns to **OK**.
- **Empty result state:** Set a special status to return when the query returns no results.
- **Template:** You can choose to send notifications using the default template or a custom template. The following list explains each template type:  Ask Genie

- **Use default template:** Alert notification is a message with links to the Alert configuration screen and the Query screen.
- **Use custom template:** Alert notification includes more specific information about the alert.

a. A box displays, consisting of input fields for subject and body. Any static content is valid, and you can incorporate built-in template variables:

- **ALERT_STATUS:** The evaluated alert status (string).
- **ALERT_CONDITION:** The alert condition operator (string).
- **ALERT_THRESHOLD:** The alert threshold (string or number).
- **ALERT_COLUMN:** The alert column name (string).
- **ALERT_NAME:** The alert name (string).
- **ALERT_URL:** The alert page URL (string).
- **QUERY_RESULT_TABLE:** The query result HTML table (string). Results are limited to the first 100 rows. Only email notification destinations can render HTML.
- **QUERY_RESULT_VALUE:** The query result value (string or number).
- **QUERY_RESULT_ROWS:** The query result rows (value array).
- **QUERY_RESULT_COLS:** The query result columns (string array).

An example subject, for instance, could be: Alert "{{ALERT_NAME}}" changed status to {{ALERT_STATUS}}.

b. You can use HTML to format messages in a custom template. Only email notification destinations can render HTML. The following tags and attributes are allowed in templates:

- **Allowed tags:** <a>, , <blockquote>,
, <code>, , <div>, , <h1>, <h2>, <h3>, <h4>, <h5>, <h6>, <hr>, <i>, , , , <p>, <pre>, , <table>, <thead>, <tbody>, <td>, <th>, <tr>, <u>,
- **Allowed attributes:**

Attribute	Supported tags
href	<a>
title	
target	<a>
alt	
src	
start	, <blockquote>, <code>, , , <hr>, <i>, <pre>, <u>

c. Click the **Preview** toggle button to preview the rendered result.

❗ IMPORTANT

The preview is useful for verifying that template variables are rendered correctly. It is not an accurate representation of the eventual notification content, as each notification destination can display notifications differently.

Workspace admins can set up new notification destinations. See [Manage notification destinations](#).

Alert aggregations

An aggregation on an alert works by modifying the original SQL of the Databricks SQL query attached to the alert. The alert wraps the original query text in a common table expression (CTE) and performs a wrapping aggregation query on it to aggregate the query result.

As an example, a `SUM` aggregation on an alert attached to a query with text `SELECT 1 AS column_name` means that whenever the alert is refreshed, the modified SQL that

runs would be: `WITH q AS (SELECT 1 AS column_name) SELECT SUM(column_name) FROM q.`

This means that the original query result (pre-aggregated) cannot be shown in an alert custom body (with parameters such as `QUERY_RESULT_ROWS` and `QUERY_RESULT_COLS`) whenever there is an aggregation on an alert. Instead, those variables will only display the final, post-aggregation query result.

Alert on multiple columns

To set an alert based on multiple columns of a query, your query can implement the alert logic and return a boolean value for the alert to trigger on. For example:

SQL

```
SELECT CASE WHEN drafts_count > 10000 AND archived_count > 5000 THEN 1
ELSE 0 END
FROM (
SELECT sum(CASE WHEN is_archived THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) AS archived_count,
sum(CASE WHEN is_draft THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) AS drafts_count
FROM queries) data
```

This query returns `1` when `drafts_count > 10000` and `archived_count > 5000`. Then you can configure the alert to trigger when the value is `1`.

Alert on metric views

Because metric views are designed to track and measure core business metrics, they pair well with alerts so that you can be automatically notified when a metric falls outside of an expected range. Alerts on metric views work in the same way as an alert on any other dataset. When you write the query to configure the query, use the fully qualified name of the metric view you want to monitor.

How Git integration works with alerts

You can use Databricks Git folders to track and manage changes to alerts. To track alerts with Git, place them in a Databricks Git folder. Newly cloned alerts only appear in the alerts list page or API after a user interacts with them. They have paused schedules and need to be explicitly resumed by users.

Databricks Git folders provide a centralized way to manage common Git operations for alerts and other workspace objects. To learn more, see [Databricks Git folders](#).

Differences from legacy alerts

The latest version of Databricks SQL alerts behaves differently from legacy alerts in a few key ways:

- **Jobs integration:** You can use a SQL alert task to evaluate alerts as part of a Lakeflow Jobs pipeline. This feature is in Beta. To learn more, see [SQL alert task for jobs](#).
- **Query reuse:** An existing saved SQL query cannot be reused when creating an alert. Each alert owns its query definition, which can be authored directly in the new alert editor.
- **Alert status values:** Alert states are simplified and alerts no longer support the `UNKNOWN` status from legacy alerts. Evaluations resolve to `OK`, `TRIGGERED`, or `ERROR`.

You can continue to use both the latest alerts and legacy alerts side by side while you transition.

Configure alert permissions and transfer alert ownership

For alert permission levels, see [Alerts ACLs](#).

1. In the sidebar, click **Alerts**.
2. Click an alert.
3. Click **Share** in the upper-right corner of the alert detail page to open the **Sharing** dialog.

Sharing: My alert ×

Do you want information about permission levels? [Learn more](#) ⚙️

Type to add multiple users or groups ▼

👤 Admins	Can Manage (inherited)
----------	------------------------

🔗 Copy link

4. Search for and select the groups and users, and assign the permission level.
5. Click **Add**.

Transfer ownership of an alert

When you save an alert, you become the alert's owner. If an alert's owner is removed from a workspace, the alert no longer has an owner. A workspace admin user can transfer ownership of an alert to a different user. You can also transfer ownership using the [Permissions API](#).

1. As a workspace admin, log in to your Databricks workspace.
2. In the sidebar, click **Alerts**.
3. Click an alert.
4. Click the **Share** button at the top right to open the **Sharing** dialog.
5. Click on the gear icon at the top right and click **Assign new owner**.

Sharing: ×

Do you want information about permission levels? [Learn more](#) ⚙️👤

6. Select the user to assign ownership to.
7. Click **Confirm**.

Is this page

as this page helpful?

☐ Yes	☐ No
☐ Send feedback	

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What are legacy alerts?

Legacy alerts are the first version of Databricks SQL alerts, which function to periodically run queries, evaluate defined conditions, and send notifications if a condition is met. You can set up alerts to monitor your business and send notifications when reported data falls outside of expected limits. Scheduling an alert executes its underlying query and checks the alert criteria. This is independent of any schedule that might exist on the underlying query.

NOTE

The latest version of Databricks SQL alerts unifies all aspects of creating and managing alerts in a single UI. It is in [Public Preview](#). To learn more, see [Databricks SQL alerts](#).

View and organize alerts

Use one of the following options to access alerts:

- Click the  **Workspace** in the sidebar to view alerts in the **Home** folder, where they are stored by default. Users can organize alerts into folders in the workspace browser along with other Databricks objects.
- Click the  **Alerts** in the sidebar to view the alerts listing page.

By default, objects are sorted in reverse chronological order. You can reorder the list by clicking the column headings. Click the **All alerts** tab near the top of the screen to view all alerts in the workspace. Click the **My alerts** tab to view alerts where you are the owner.

- Name** shows the string name of each alert.
- State** shows whether the alert status is `TRIGGERED`, `OK`, or `UNKNOWN`.
- Last Updated** shows the last updated time or date.

 Ask Genie

- **Created at** shows the date and time the alert was created.
 - **TRIGGERED** means that on the most recent execution, the Value column in your target query met the Condition and Threshold you configured. If your alert checks whether “cats” is above 1500, your alert will be triggered as long as “cats” is above 1500.
 - **OK** means that on the most recent query execution, the Value column did not meet the Condition and Threshold you configured. This doesn’t mean that the Alert was not previously triggered. If your “cats” value is now 1470, your alert will show as **OK**.
 - **UNKNOWN** means Databricks does not have enough data to evaluate the alert criteria. You will see this status immediately after creating your Alert and until the query has executed. You will also see this status if there was no data in the query result or if the most recent query result doesn’t include the *Value Column* you configured.

Create an alert

Follow these steps to create an alert on a single column of a query.

❗ IMPORTANT

- Alerts leveraging queries with [parameters](#) use the default value specified in the SQL editor for each parameter.

1. Do one of the following:

- Click  **New** in the sidebar and select **Alert**.
- Click  **Alerts** in the sidebar and click the **+ New Alert** button.
- Click  **Workspace** in the sidebar and click **+ Create Alert**.

2. In the **Query** field, search for a target query.

New alert

Alert name [Setup Instructions ?](#)

Query

To alert on multiple columns, you need to modify your query. See [Alert aggregations](#).

3. In the **Trigger condition** field, configure the alert.

- The **Value column** drop-down controls which field of your query result is evaluated. Alert conditions can be set on the first value of a column in the query result, or you can choose to set an aggregation across all the rows of a single column, such as SUM or AVERAGE.

Trigger condition

Value column

Operator

Threshold value

[Preview alert](#)

Notifications

When alert is triggered

Send notification ☐

Template

- The **Operator** drop-down controls the logical operation to be applied.
- The **Threshold value** text input is compared against the Value column using the Condition you specify.

Trigger condition	Value column	Operator	Threshold value
	Total Price ▼	Sum ▼	> ▼
			1000

4. Click **Preview alert** to preview the alert and test whether the alert would trigger with the current data.

5. In the **When alert is triggered, send notification** field, select how many notifications are sent when your alert is triggered:

- **Just once:** Send a notification when the **alert status** changes from **OK** to **TRIGGERED**.
- **Each time alert is evaluated:** Send a notification whenever the alert status is **TRIGGERED** regardless of its status at the previous evaluation.
- **At most every:** Send a notification whenever the alert status is **TRIGGERED** at a specific interval. This choice lets you avoid notification spam for alerts that trigger often.

Regardless of which notification setting you choose, you receive a notification whenever the status goes from **OK** to **TRIGGERED** or from **TRIGGERED** to **OK**. The schedule settings affect how many notifications you will receive if the status remains **TRIGGERED** from one execution to the next. For details, see [Notification frequency](#).

6. In the **Template** drop-down, choose a template:

- **Use default template:** Alert notification is a message with links to the Alert configuration screen and the Query screen.
- **Use custom template:** Alert notification includes more specific information about the alert.

a. A box displays, consisting of input fields for subject and body. Any static content is valid, and you can incorporate built-in template variables:

- **ALERT_STATUS:** The evaluated alert status (string).
- **ALERT_CONDITION:** The alert condition operator (string).
- **ALERT_THRESHOLD:** The alert threshold (string or number).
- **ALERT_COLUMN:** The alert column name (string).

- `ALERT_NAME`: The alert name (string).
- `ALERT_URL`: The alert page URL (string).
- `QUERY_NAME`: The associated query name (string).
- `QUERY_URL`: The associated query page URL (string).
- `QUERY_RESULT_TABLE`: The query result HTML table (string). Results are limited to the first 100 rows. Only email notification destinations can render HTML.
- `QUERY_RESULT_VALUE`: The query result value (string or number).
- `QUERY_RESULT_ROWS`: The query result rows (value array).
- `QUERY_RESULT_COLS`: The query result columns (string array).

An example subject, for instance, could be: `Alert "{{ALERT_NAME}}"`
changed status to `{{ALERT_STATUS}}`.

b. You can use HTML to format messages in a custom template. Only email notification destinations can render HTML. The following tags and attributes are allowed in templates:

- Tags: `<a>`, `<abbr>`, `<acronym>`, `<b>`, `<blockquote>`, `<body>`, `<br>`, `<code>`, `<div>`, `<em>`, `<h1>`, `<h2>`, `<h3>`, `<h4>`, `<h5>`, `<h6>`, `<head>`, `<hr>`, `<html>`, `<i>`, `<li>`, `<ol>`, `<p>`, `<span>`, `<strong>`, `<table>`, `<tbody>`, `<td>`, `<th>`, `<tr>`, `<ul>`
- Attributes: href (for `<a>`), title (for `<a>`, `<abbr>`, `<acronym>`)

c. Click the **Preview** toggle button to preview the rendered result.

❗ IMPORTANT

The preview is useful for verifying that template variables are rendered correctly. It is not an accurate representation of the eventual notification content, as each notification destination can display notifications differently.

d. Click the **Save Changes** button.

7. Click **Create Alert**.

8. Click **Add Schedule**.

- Use the dropdown pickers to specify the frequency, period, starting time, and time zone. Optionally, select the **Show cron syntax** checkbox to edit the schedule in [Quartz Cron Syntax](#).
- Choose **More options** to show optional settings. You can also choose:
 - A name for the schedule.
 - A SQL warehouse to power the query. By default, the SQL warehouse used for ad hoc query execution is also used for a scheduled job. Use this optional setting to select a different warehouse to run the scheduled query.

9. Click the **Destinations** tab in the **Add schedule** dialog.

- Use the drop-down to select an available [notification destination](#). Or, start typing a username to add individuals.

❗ IMPORTANT

If you skip this step you *will not* be notified when the alert is triggered.

10. Click **Create**. Your saved alert and notification details appear on the screen.

Workspace > Users > @databricks.com

Demo alert ☆

UNKNOWN

Share [Edit](#) [Refresh](#)

Last triggered at None

Query [Order Revenue](#)

Trigger condition

Value column	Operator	Threshold value
Total Price Sum	>	1000

Notifications

When alert is triggered

Send notification just once, until back to normal.

When alert returns back to normal

☐ Send notification

Template Set to default notification template.

Schedules	Destinations
Demo alert - Every 1 hour Every 1 hour (America/New_York) i@databricks.com No runs Add schedule	

11. Share the schedule.

- To the right of the listed schedule, choose the kebab menu and select **Edit schedule permissions**.
- Choose a user or group from the drop-down menu in the dialog.
- Choose out of the following schedule permissions:
 - **NO PERMISSIONS:** No permissions have been granted. Users with no permissions cannot see that the schedule exists, even if they are subscribers or included in listed notification destinations.
 - **CAN VIEW:** Grants permission to view scheduled run results.
 - **CAN MANAGE RUN:** Grants permission to view scheduled run results.
 - **CAN MANAGE:** Grants permission to view, modify, and delete schedules. This permission is required in order to make changes to the run interval, update the subscriber list, and pause or unpause the schedule.
 - **IS OWNER:** Grants all permissions of CAN MANAGE. Additionally, the credentials of the schedule owner will be used to run dashboard queries. Only a workspace admin can change the owner.

❗ IMPORTANT

Permissions for alerts and schedules are separate. Grant access to users and groups in the notifications destinations list so they can view scheduled run results.

12. Share the alert.

- Click [Share](#) near the upper-right corner of the page.

- Add users or groups who should have access to the alert.
- Choose the appropriate permission level, then click **Add**.

❗ IMPORTANT

CAN MANAGE grants permission to view, modify, and delete schedules. This permission is required in order to make changes to the run interval, update the notification destination list, and pause or unpause the schedule.

For more information on alert permission levels, see [Alerts ACLs](#).

Alert aggregations

An aggregation on an alert works by modifying the original SQL in the query attached to the alert. The alert wraps the original query text in a common table expression (CTE) and performs a wrapping aggregation query on it to aggregate the query result.

As an example, a `SUM` aggregation on an alert attached to a query with text `SELECT 1 AS column_name` means that whenever the alert is refreshed, the modified SQL that runs would be: `WITH q AS (SELECT 1 AS column_name) SELECT SUM(column_name) FROM q.`

This means that the original query result (pre-aggregated) cannot be shown in an alert custom body (with parameters such as `QUERY_RESULT_ROWS` and `QUERY_RESULT_COLS`) whenever there is an aggregation on an alert. Instead, those variables will only display the final, post-aggregation query result.

❗ NOTE

All trigger conditions related to aggregations are not supported by the API.

Alert on multiple columns

To set an alert based on multiple columns of a query, your query can implement the alert logic and return a boolean value for the alert to trigger on. For example:

SQL

```
SELECT CASE WHEN drafts_count > 10000 AND archived_count > 5000 THEN 1
ELSE 0 END
FROM (
SELECT sum(CASE WHEN is_archived THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) AS archived_count,
sum(CASE WHEN is_draft THEN 1 ELSE 0 END) AS drafts_count
FROM queries) data
```

This query returns `1` when `drafts_count > 10000` and `archived_count > 5000`. Then you can configure the alert to trigger when the value is `1`.

Alert on metric views

Because metric views are designed to track and measure core business metrics, they couple well with alerts so that you can be automatically notified when a metric falls outside of an expected range. To set an alert on a metric view, you must first write and save a query on the metric view. See [Query a metric view](#). When you set an alert, choose the saved query on your metric view as the target query. For details instructions about creating an alert, see [Create an alert](#).

Notification frequency

Databricks sends notifications to your chosen notification destinations whenever it detects that the Alert status has changed from `OK` to `TRIGGERED` or vice versa. Consider this example where an Alert is configured on a query that is scheduled to run once daily. The daily status of the Alert appears in the following table. Prior to Monday the alert status was `OK`.

Day	Alert Status
Monday	OK
Tuesday	OK
Wednesday	TRIGGERED  Ask Genie

Day	Alert Status
Thursday	TRIGGERED
Friday	TRIGGERED
Saturday	TRIGGERED
Sunday	OK

If the notification frequency is set to `Just Once`, Databricks sends a notification on Wednesday when the status changed from `OK` to `TRIGGERED` and again on Sunday when it switches back. It does not send alerts on Thursday, Friday, or Saturday unless you specifically configure it to do so because the Alert status did not change between executions on those days.

Configure alert permissions and transfer alert ownership

You must have at least CAN MANAGE permission on a query to share queries. For alert permission levels, see [Alerts ACLs](#).

1. In the sidebar, click **Alerts**.
2. Click an alert.
3. Click the Share button at the top right to open the **Sharing** dialog.

Sharing: My alert

Do you want information about permission levels? [Learn more](#)

Type to add multiple users or groups

 Admins

Can Manage (inherited)

Copy link

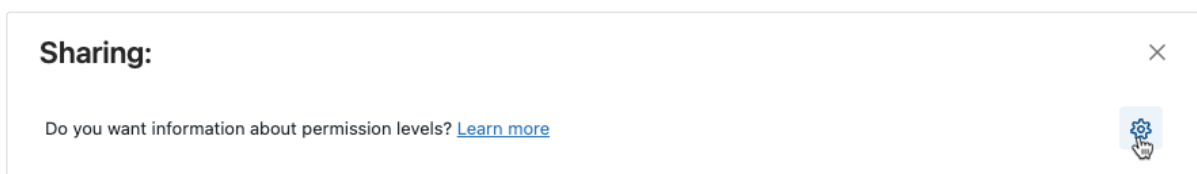
 Ask Genie

4. Search for and select the groups and users, and assign the permission level.
5. Click **Add**.

Transfer ownership of an alert

When you save an alert, you become the alert's owner. If an alert's owner is removed from a workspace, the alert no longer has an owner. A workspace admin user can transfer ownership of an alert to a different user. Service principals and groups cannot be assigned ownership of a alert. You can also transfer ownership using the [Permissions API](#).

1. As a workspace admin, log in to your Databricks workspace.
2. In the sidebar, click **Alerts**.
3. Click an alert.
4. Click the **Share** button at the top right to open the **Sharing** dialog.
5. Click on the gear icon at the top right and click **Assign new owner**.



6. Select the user to assign ownership to.
7. Click **Confirm**.

Is this page

Was this page helpful?

 Yes

 No

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